“Okay,” I said, “I’ll do that, I’ll enter my name as a favorite son, but that’s all, and only on one condition: that our delegation be representative of all sides in this split, not just one group.” They promised to balance the delegation—and they did.

After the word leaked out of my agreement to run as a favorite son in the primary, I began getting calls from Republicans around the country asking me if it was true that my name was going to be placed in nomination as a candidate.

I’d say, “Well, yes, because that goes with being a favorite son, but I’m not *running* for president.” Then, they’d say, “That’s all we wanted to know; we’re going to consider you a real candidate and campaign on that basis.”

Then I replied: “I’ll have to repudiate you if you do that—I’m not a *real* candidate.”

“We know that,” they’d say, “but we’re going to do it anyway.”

As I traveled around the country on the speech circuit that spring, preaching Republicanism and the Eleventh Commandment, I ran into some of these people, repeated what I’d told them on the phone, and declined to let them place my name on state primary ballots. But that still didn’t stop it. A lot of top Republicans in California kept telling me I was foolish not to launch an all-out bid for the nomination, but I said I didn’t want to run for the presidency and I meant it.

By the time the convention opened in Miami Beach in early August, George Romney had lost his initial momentum and the race had boiled down to a battle between Rockefeller and Nixon, who was completing his great political comeback after the defeats of 1960 and 1962. When I arrived at the convention, I was surprised to learn quite a few delegates had pledged their support to me, but I